

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- A new "Stop School Cuts" report from ASCL, NEU and NAHT finds schools are £4.5bn worse off in real terms than in 2010 — nearly three-quarters of schools down on per-pupil funding, with £300m lost in the last year alone.

→ **For your school:** Useful sector-wide context if you're making the case locally for protecting inclusion spend against wider budget pressure.

- The NEU has confirmed a formal strike ballot of teachers in England will run 3 October–15 December over pay and funding, after its executive stopped short of also balloting support staff.

→ **For your school:** Worth an early heads-up to SLT — a December ballot result could mean action landing in the new year.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

18 Sep 2026 — DfE EOTAS (education otherwise than at school) consultation closes.

18 Sep 2026 — Rotherham Schools Forum meets — agenda includes the exclusion & suspensions annual report and an EHCP update.

3 Oct 2026 — NEU formal strike ballot of teachers opens in England (closes 15 Dec).

NATIONAL POLICY & FUNDING

- **Unions warn schools are £4.5bn worse off since 2010.** The Stop School Cuts coalition (ASCL, NEU, NAHT) published new real-terms analysis this week showing nearly three-quarters of schools have less per-pupil funding than in 2010, with over 3,700 schools down more than £1,000 per pupil and schools losing £300m in the last year alone. ([Schools Week](#))

→ **For your school:** Sector-wide figures worth citing if you're pressing for inclusion funding to be protected in any in-year budget conversation.

WORKFORCE & INDUSTRIAL RELATIONS

- **NEU confirms formal strike ballot timetable.** The union's national executive confirmed a formal ballot of the 280,000+ teachers it represents in England will run 3 October to 15 December over pay and funding, after an earlier indicative ballot saw over 90% of participating teachers say they'd be willing to take action; a parallel ballot of support staff was not agreed by the executive. ([National Education Union](#))

→ **For your school:** A result in mid-December would land right before spring-term planning — worth flagging to SLT now.

FROM THE CORRIDOR

It's a quieter few days on the national wires — a good window to get ahead of the EOTAS consultation before it closes 18 September.

Editor's note

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.